

IS THERE A POWER TO POSITIVE THINKING?

Picture two people being interviewed for the same job. One is well dressed and oozes confidence. The other is flustered and a bag of nerves. The first one has a positive mental attitude, while the other focuses only on personal weaknesses. No prizes for guessing who gets the job. People say anything is possible with positive thinking. Imagine lifting a whale, for example! But does it really work?

ETERNAL OPTIMIST

Fill a glass halfway and ask someone to describe what they see. While an optimist says it is half full, a pessimist says it is half empty. Similarly, an optimist sees light at the end of the tunnel and hurries to it. A pessimist fears it is an oncoming train and flattens himself against the wall.

"SINCE THE HOUSE IS ON FIRE, LET US WARM OURSELVES."

Italian proverb

DONT WORRY, BE HAPPY

Optimists are cheerful people who always expect things to turn out well. Most people believe that optimists are more successful in life, feel healthier, and get better jobs, while pessimists are so full of doom and gloom that they expect to fail and never achieve anything. The key to success is attitude: if you are happy and feel positive, you'll be a winner.

COGNITIVE THERAPY

One way of treating patients who suffer from anxiety, depression, and other psychological disorders is cognitive therapy. People learn to recognize the patterns of negative thoughts they have about themselves and replace them with positive ones. By reprogramming their minds to filter out the gloomy thoughts and focus on things they can do well, patients learn to live happier, more fulfilling lives.

GET GIGGLING

Laughter really is the best medicine. When you laugh, increased amounts of a chemical called serotonin are released into the brain. Known as the "feel-good hormone," serotonin helps lift your mood when things seem blue. Some researchers think laughter boosts the body's immune system, so you can fight infections, too.

